

Milena Monova

Technology & Product Leader

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PROFILE

Technology and engineering leader with 10+ years of experience, starting as a backend engineer and moving through software architecture, CTO and co-founder, technical product management, and engineering leadership.

I've built products from scratch, designed technical architecture, led small engineering teams, worked directly with users and commercial teams, and helped turn early ideas into working products. I'm at my best in smaller companies where I can stay close to the technology and product while developing people and building a strong engineering team.

I care a lot about what I work on and want to build technology I genuinely believe is useful.

EXPERIENCE

Equilibrium Markets (Remote)

Food supply-chain technology company improving transparency and access to local food in UK public-sector procurement.

Mar 2024 - Present

Engineering Team Director

Jan 2026 - Present

- Lead and coach the engineering team, with responsibility for performance, development, resourcing and hiring.
- Created a 12-month upskilling programme that combines individual career goals with company needs, including skills and KPIs, mentorship partners, targeted work assignments and dedicated budgets for courses and events.
- Used the programme to spread knowledge and ownership across the team, reducing dependency on the Tech Lead as a single point of failure while giving other engineers opportunities to take on greater responsibility.
- Created and introduced a repeatable innovation process, including facilitated ideation and Prototype Days. Coached teams to turn ideas into one-day prototypes and transferred ownership of the process so it now runs independently.
- Own engineering recruitment needs and role definition, including defining the team's QA requirements, writing the role and screening candidates for the team's first dedicated QA hire.

Technical Product Manager

Mar 2025–2026

- Took ownership of product and engineering planning during a critical period when the team was working against unclear requirements and a short deadline to prepare the platform for user onboarding.
- Worked directly with the Supply Chain Manager to turn business and user requirements into functional specifications before development, reducing vague or unnecessary work reaching engineering.
- Introduced the team's first roadmap and a RICE-based prioritisation framework, and ran sprint planning, retrospectives, dailies and the wider Scrum process.
- Brought greater structure and predictability to engineering delivery, helping the team meet the onboarding deadline while reducing developer frustration around unclear requirements and priorities.

Integration Lead & Backend Consultant

Mar 2024 - Mar 2025

- Joined at 20% FTE to help build EM's supply-chain platform from scratch, taking ownership of its distributor integrations.
- Designed and built integrations with four food distributors using EDI, FTP and distributor-specific standards, as well as an API integration with Erudus; all five integrations went successfully into production.
- Worked directly with distributor technical teams throughout the integration process, owning technical communication, requirements and coordination through to production launch.

Collaberry (Remote)

Open-source dynamic compensation product for collaborative organisations, combining contribution assessment with transparent reward allocation.

Founder / Product & Technology Lead

Jan 2024 - Apr 2025

- Started Collaberry after a three-month RnDAO research fellowship on compensation in early-stage teams, resulting in a published research paper and a model for dynamic compensation based on peer-assessed contribution.
- Designed the TeamPoints methodology and initially ran it manually using Excel and Google Forms, testing monthly compensation cycles with 5–10 organisations for several months before building software.
- Secured ~\$38k in grant and public-goods funding, including an Arbitrum grant and Bitcoin funding, and used Collaberry's own dynamic compensation model to build a contributor team while extending the project's runway.
- Led product decisions and built the backend and infrastructure, working with contributors across frontend, UX/design, product and marketing.
- Moved the organisations that had validated the manual process onto the software product; they continued using it after I stepped away.

Aut Labs (Remote)

Venture-backed startup building role-based governance and coordination infrastructure for digital organisations, backed by nearly €2M in pre-seed funding.

CTO & Co-founder

Feb 2021 - Jun 2023

- Co-founded the company after winning an early Web3 hackathon and later joining the Filecoin Launchpad Accelerator, powered by Tachyon, turning an experimental project into a funded startup.
- Designed and built the core blockchain protocol, introducing on-chain identity, skills and roles as the foundation for role-based membership and governance.
- Built and led the engineering team, hiring frontend, full-stack and smart-contract developers while remaining hands-on with protocol development; owned architecture, technical delivery and mentoring.
- Took the first developer product to market through hackathons including ETHGlobal, using sponsored integration bounties to test the developer experience, documentation and product proposition with external developers.
- Used those findings to lead a product pivot from identity/authentication infrastructure to a modular platform for building and managing digital organisations, with plug-and-play governance and reputation modules.
- Worked with ecosystem partners including Polygon and supported the technical side of fundraising, preparing technical investor materials and participating in investor calls.

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Software Architect

2020–2021

- Worked on the architecture and modernisation of EM's legacy food supply-chain platform, improving the technical foundation for future development.
- Improved the reliability and maintainability of a legacy platform while building a stronger technical foundation for future development.

ScaleFocus (Sofia, Bulgaria)

Software engineering consultancy building products for international clients.

Software Engineer

May 2019 - Jan 2020

- Designed and built backend and distributed systems for a US healthcare product developed from the ground up, working primarily with Node.js and Go.
- Took ownership of technical design for key parts of the backend and distributed infrastructure.

Centroida (Sofia, Bulgaria)

Software development company specialising in distributed systems and emerging technologies.

Software Engineer Jun 2016 - May 2019

- Built backend and distributed systems across multiple products, progressively taking on more responsibility for technical design and delivery.
- Supported junior engineers and contributed to architecture and technical decisions as the team grew.

Mathematics Teacher

Sofia

Independent 2016-2024

- Taught secondary-school mathematics, particularly working with students who struggled with traditional teaching approaches.
- Adapted teaching methods to individual students, focusing on understanding and problem-solving rather than memorisation.

EDUCATION

Sofia University

Bachelors

Computer Science 2014-2018

SKILLS

♥ **Product Strategy · Product Discovery · User Research · Zero-to-One Product Development · Engineering Leadership · People Management · Technical Strategy · Software Architecture · Organisational Development**

